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## **COLLEGE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY**

### **IT 113 – Systems Administration and Maintenance Post Assessment 1**

Discuss the following question for at least 3-5 paragraphs only.

1. What do you know about the active directory in system administration?
2. What is group policy?
3. Can you tell us about the experience you have with hardware Components?
4. What according to you could be the personal characteristics of a person administering a system?
5. Can you give us one of the examples of the systems you have been working with as an Administrator?
6. What is the difference between a workgroup and a domain?
7. If you are a system administrator what will be your daily routine?
8. According to you why backing up an active directory is important and how can you backup an active Directory?
9. Can you tell us about the Windows registry?
10. What do you know about Windows deployment services?

#### **Answer:**

[<sup>1</sup>] The Active Directory is a centralized database with Windows Server operating systems that helps system administrators efficiently manage network resources. This is made possible through authentication, authorization, and other networking services along with easing user management tasks. [<sup>2</sup>] Active Directory is complemented by Group Policy that enables administrators to enforce specific configurations and settings for users and computers across the network. Through Group Policy, security settings, software installations, and desktop configuration are defined by administrators thereby ensuring uniformity and safety within the entire network.

[<sup>3</sup>] In my experience with hardware components such as CPUs, GPUs, RAM storage drives, and peripherals I have gained comprehensive knowledge about how they function, the

ways of installing them, and fixing any problems related to them. Through this expertise, I can effectively maintain and optimize hardware infrastructure that ensures optimal system performance and reliability. <sup>[4]</sup> Technical proficiency, problem-solving skills, adaptability, and good communication skills are some of those personal traits that are crucial when administering a system. Thus, patience coupled with a proactive mindset together with a commitment to learning continuously will help in navigating through complexities associated with successful systems management.

<sup>[5]</sup> Being an Administrator, I have dealt much with Windows Server environments where Active Directory is used in the authentication of users and management of resources.

This required configuring domain controllers as well as control over user accounts and permissions, deploying group policies, troubleshooting system issues, and ensuring that network stability and security were maintained. <sup>[6]</sup> Furthermore, I know what sets apart a workgroup from a domain; while for a workgroup to operate all peers will be able to share files without having centralized management domains are structured places where resources are managed centrally through an active directory which enhances security and organization.

<sup>[7]</sup> In my day-to-day activities as a systems administrator, some of the tasks usually performed include monitoring system performance, managing user accounts & permissions, solving technical problems, making backups & updates on systems as well as putting in place security measures liaising with IT personnel among others. Failure to back up an active directory would imply that no disaster recovery from a business continuity point of view can be achieved since backup enables restoration of lost data or corrupted ones or recovery from system failures. <sup>[8]</sup> There are different types of backups such as full daily incremental differential backups including built-in Windows server backup tools third-party software or specialized active directory backup software.

<sup>[9]</sup> Lastly, a hierarchical database called Windows Registry is used for storing configuration settings of the Windows operating system and applications installed in it and plays an important part in the administration of a computer. The register enables system administrators to work with them in many ways, including making changes to system behavior, solving problems that may arise as well as propagating any modifications across various systems. <sup>[10]</sup> Windows Deployment Services (WDS) also automate the installation process for Windows OS images through network deployment which can then be deployed onto new or existing computers reducing setup time and effort involved. When combined, these elements enable the management of resources on a network by systems, and keep IT infrastructure stable and secure, while maximizing overall performance.